Teaching Philosophy

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My teaching philosophy has been shaped by an academic and professional journey spanning Mexico, China, and Canada. At the University of Regina, this journey has unfolded across three distinct faculties: the Faculty of Science, the Faculty of Media, Art, and Performance, and the Faculty of Arts. Trained initially in Electronics and Telecommunications Engineering, I discovered that technology's deepest value emerges when it serves as a medium for creativity, culture, and inclusion. As a Latin American educator and researcher, I believe that teaching is about more than software proficiency. It is about empowering diverse students to become innovative creators, empathetic collaborators, and socially responsible technologists.

Teaching as Interdisciplinary Collaboration

Having taught in the Faculty of Science, the Faculty of Media, Art, and Performance, and the Faculty of Arts, I have learned to navigate and bridge different disciplinary languages. My teaching experience ranges from foundational Computer Science courses (**CS 100**, **CS 215**), to upper-level production and design courses (**CS 408**, **CTCH/DES 312**), to language acquisition labs (**SPAN 100s and 200s**). Each course emphasizes hands-on exploration, teamwork, iterative design, and critical reflection, encouraging students to integrate artistic expression with technical precision.

My approach is collaborative and adaptive. When teaching with specialized hardware, whether VR headsets, Arduino kits, or multimedia equipment, not all students have equal access. I form balanced teams where each student has a role (operating equipment, developing assets, managing technical integration, or documenting processes) so that learning continues uninterrupted. This cooperative model builds technical skill, creativity, and empathy while fostering a supportive and inclusive environment. In language labs, this same collaborative ethos applies, where peer-to-peer conversation and cultural exchange replace hardware with human connection.

Linking Creativity, Research, and Industry

In every course, I aim to cultivate both technical mastery and creative autonomy. Students learn to use industry-standard tools, but beyond technical fluency, I emphasize storytelling, identity, and social impact. I prepare students for two complementary career paths: joining Canada's growing creative and interactive media industry, or pursuing research and academic work in emerging fields.

To bridge academia and practice, I integrate professional standards and encourage participation in community events like the Global Game Jam and Skills Canada com-

petitions. These activities connect students with local and national creative communities while building confidence, networking skills, and collaborative capacity. Similarly, in the Faculty of Arts, I connect Spanish language learners to the broader Hispanic communities within Regina and beyond.

Teaching as Inclusion and Social Engagement

My doctoral work, *Perspectives on Left-Handed Inclusion (LINC) in Computer Games*, explores how design can support atypical users often overlooked in mainstream interfaces. This research informs my teaching: I encourage students to critically examine who technologies serve, how interfaces include or exclude, and how creative technologies can promote social justice and equitable engagement.

My identity and community work as a Latin American academic, including my past service on the Board of Directors of the Latinos en Regina Association (LRA), also shape my pedagogy. I see education as a form of community building. Through organizing cultural events and performances, I have learned that creative technologies and language can foster empathy, cross-cultural understanding, and social responsibility. In class, I emphasize that inclusion is a lived experience, using case studies like *Mainichi* and *That Dragon, Cancer* to discuss accessibility, representation, and ethical design. Students also explore accessibility challenges, including photosensitive epilepsy, migraines triggered by flashing lights, and colorblindness, helping them understand accessibility as a creative and ethical responsibility.

Lifelong Learning and Reflective Practice

I believe learning is a reciprocal, lifelong process. The Graduate Student Teaching Development Program at the University of Regina introduced me to anti-oppressive teaching, Indigenizing curriculum, and student-centered learning, principles I continue to apply. I actively incorporate student feedback and advocate for flexible assessment methods beyond exams, using group projects, presentations, and critical reflections to allow students to demonstrate learning creatively.

Looking Ahead

At its core, my teaching philosophy holds that technology, language, and creativity are most powerful when they empower people to connect, question, and imagine together. Whether students are building interactive games, designing user interfaces, programming software, practicing a new language, or exploring cultural media, I want them to see themselves not just as users of technology, but as shapers of a more inclusive, creative, and compassionate future.